

Built for speed

Reaching around 45 mph (72 kph), dragonflies are the fastest flying insects. They can fly forward, backward, up, and down. Each of their light and strong wings can be moved independently.



Dragonfly

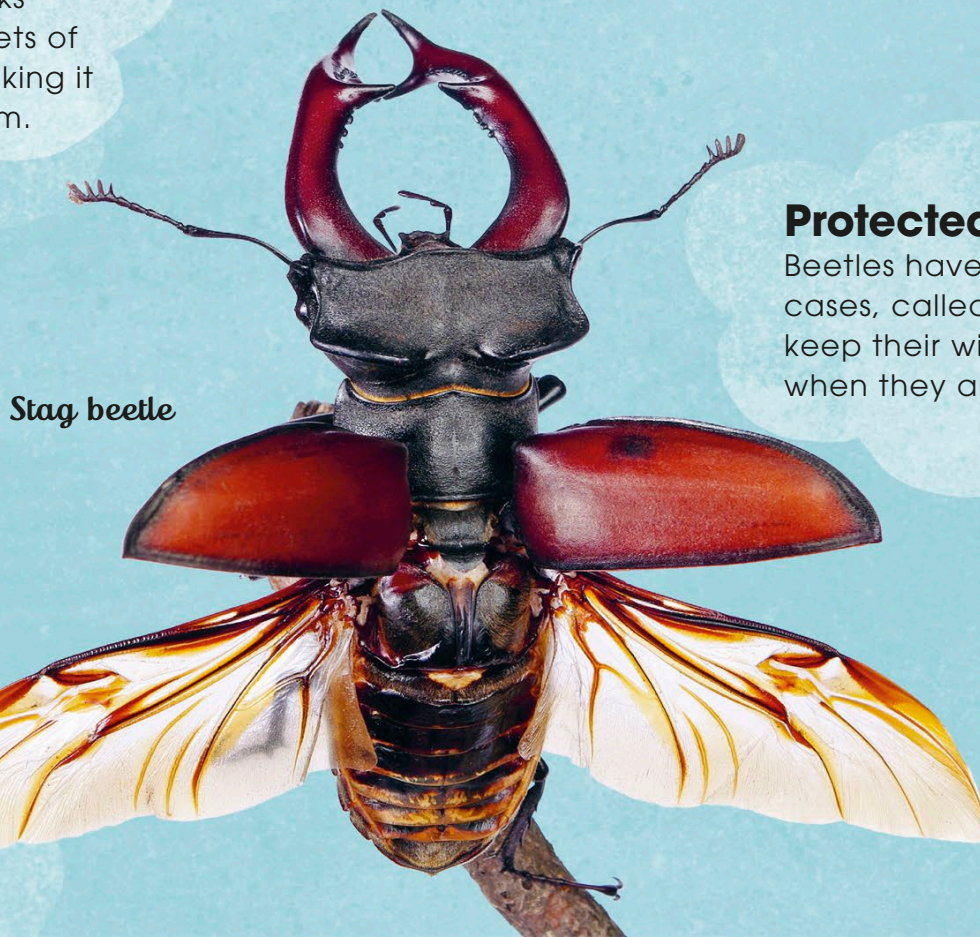
Some insects move their wings using muscles; others do it by changing the shape of their thorax.



Bee

Hooked wings

Bees have tiny hooks that link their two sets of wings together, making it easier to move them.



Stag beetle

Protected wings

Beetles have hard wing cases, called elytra, to keep their wings safe when they are not flying.